

Modelling the syntax-discourse interface: a syntactic analysis of *please*

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1 Introduction and roadmap

In this paper I argue for a structural representation of speech acts in the form of a speech act projection at the top of the clausal spine. I will show that *please* in English takes two forms and that one of these is the head of the speech act projection which imbues an utterance with ‘requesting’ force. The other type of *please* is an adverb-like particle which is not part of the main functional structure of the clause.

1.1 Why would speech acts be structurally represented?

Motivation: Recent interest in perspective and point of view, syntacticisation of perspective and what the syntactic and semantic status of a speech act really is

— A variety of versions of a speech act projection have been produced... but how do they compare, and do they generalise across languages?

Focus: the English ‘pragmatic marker’ *please* - its distribution, characteristics and uses prove an interesting test ground for previously proposed speech act projections in English

Aims: work towards a syntactic analysis of *please*; examine strengths and weaknesses of different speech act projection structures¹

1.2 Roadmap

- Background: speech acts in syntax and approaches to date
- A possible candidate for the speech act head in English: *please*
 - Analyses of *please*: from speech act theory to politeness and back

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- Distribution and acquisition of *please*: corpus data from English dialects
- Two types of *please*: speech act and non-speech act
- Consequences for theories of speech act projections
- Conclusions

2 Speech acts in syntax: approaches to date

2.1 Ross (1970)

- Based on data concerning antecedentless reflexive pronouns and deleted arguments, Ross suggested that every illocutionary act contains a performative verb
 - This performative verb has a first-person subject (I) and a second-person object (you)
 - This argument structure is always present, but deleted via ‘performative deletion’ in non-overtly performative sentences (see (1))
- (1) a. I promise you I will come for dinner
 b. I will come for dinner = ~~I promise you~~ I will come for dinner
- Ross also entertains the idea of a “pragmatic analysis”; hierarchically-arranged referents of discourse participants outside of but accessible to syntax

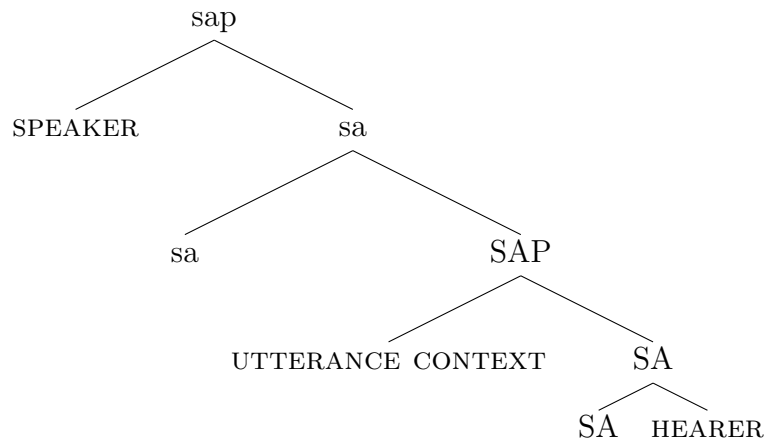
2.2 Speas & Tenny (2003)

- Speas & Tenny (2003, henceforth S&T) envisage a syntactic representation of speaker and addressee operators motivated by:
 - Bringing together the intuition of discourse participants in the syntax with established restrictions on the role of pragmatic forces within grammar
 - Apparent hierarchical organisation of discourse participants
- S&T refute the idea that certain speech acts are tied to certain clause types, as questions can be answered with questions and declarative sentences can encode implicit requests and so on
 - Crucially, S&T question whether Ross’s analysis should be restricted to just performative declarative sentences after all, as there are many different types of sentence which are subject to illocutionary force and which have implications for speakers and hearers
- S&T observe that Cinque’s (1999) Mood_{SpeechAct} projection is overt in any language which contains elements such as interrogative morphemes and sentence particles, i.e. is not limited to performative declarative clauses Speas & Tenny (2003, p.317).

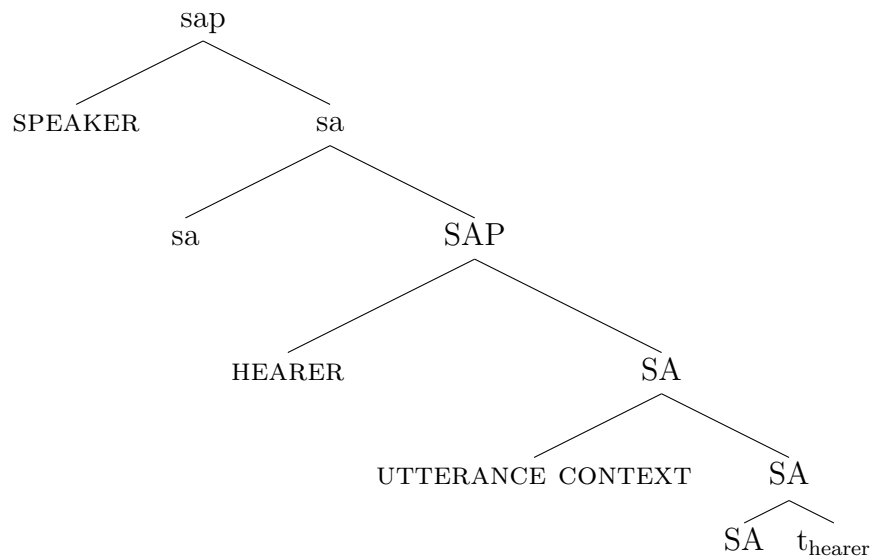
- S&T's proposal:

- Speaker and the addressee are represented as arguments within the extended Speech Act Phrase (at the top of the clausal spine) along with an operator-like representation
- Different structures for declarative (2) and interrogative (3) sentences: the hearer is moved to a higher position in the tree in the interrogative case, analogously to dative movement of the indirect object.²

(2)



(3)



- Criticism:

- S&T motivate the declarative configuration on the idea of the UC as the theme and the hearer as the goal of the utterance, though this would typically see the UC generated as the complement to SA (cf. Bruening (2010)).
- Why should dative-like movement (of the hearer) should apply in this context, and what motivates it?

²sap and SAP are both Speech Act projections, with sap as a shell to SAP.

2.3 Extending Speas and Tenny's ideas

- A number of scholars have taken S&T's ideas and amended them, both for theoretical and empirical reasons:
 - Hill (2007a): the behaviour of sentence-initial particles in Romanian such as *hai* ('come on'); **suggests that such particles which relate to certain clause types are the head of the SA projection**; rejects concept of "dative movement" of the hearer and proposes a single SAP (like a three-place predicate) in which speaker and addressee are always present
 - Miyagawa (2012): allocutive agreement in Basque and honorific agreement in Japanese, syntactically represented *addressee* is antecedent for such agreement (similar aims to S&T using a more Hill-like structure)
 - Haegeman (2014): discourse particles in West Flemish, their distribution w.r.t vocatives and their positioning within the sentence; proposes that multiple SAPs are possible
 - Woods (2014b): shifting of speaker-oriented adverbs in English (and French and Greek); addressee only represented in certain clause types which 'require' the involvement of an addressee; moves away from representing discourse participants for agreement purposes (like Hill and Haegeman)
- All of these accounts vary in different, subtle ways; a problem facing the subfield of speech acts in general
- Key questions: what is the speech act head? Does it have an argument structure? To what extent is it overtly represented in (any) language?

3 Analyses of *please*

3.1 Speech act theory (philosophical/semantic) approaches

- Analyses of *please* are somewhat less numerous, and much less recent, than in the pragmatic tradition
- Sadock (1974) identifies two different *pleases* in terms of usage
 - Sentence-adverbial *please* - softens requests
"Please bring me a towel."
 - Free-standing *please* - constitutes a request in and of itself
"Please. It's cold in here."
- Sadock does not directly distinguish between clause-initial and clause-final adverbial *please*; however:
 - He notes that "distributional facts are capable of distinguishing [...] encoded force from use or effect"

- He notes that YN questions with sentence-medial *please* can only be interpreted as requests, not as information-seeking questions or as ‘survey’ questions
 - Sadock claims that *please* is not strictly a request marker, as it is not compatible with all indirect requests; compare (4a) and (4b):
- (4) From Sadock 1974, p.104
- a. Will you (please) close the door?
 - b. When will you (*please) close the door?
- Explorations of other discourse particles (esp. German *denn, ja* etc.) suggest a link between the clause type and the availability of discourse elements (cf. Coniglio & Zegrean (2012))
 - Coniglio and Zegrean note that certain discourse particles in German and Romanian are only available in certain clause types (sometimes more than one)
 - They suggest that C is split into Clause Type and Illocutionary Force
 - Each part of the split C enters into an Agree relationship with the features of the particle; failure to value any of the particle’s features leads to failure of the particle in the sentence
- (5) ILL [μ type] [val]/[i intent] [val] $\leftarrow$ intentionality valued
>CLAUSE TYPE [i type] [val] $\leftarrow$ clause type valued
>>Prt [μ type] [val]/[μ intent] [val] Coniglio & Zegrean 2012, p.249
- Work by Haegeman (2014) also looks at clause-peripheral discourse markers and their role within the speech act layer; she notes the following characteristics of such discourse markers:
 - They are not truth-conditional
 - They imply the presence of the discourse participants (“speaker and, especially, hearer” — Haegeman 2014, p.120)
 - They are directly correlated with the speech act; “may express a response to a linguistic even or to a non-linguistic even which is manifest in the speech situation” (also p.120)

3.2 Pragmatic approaches

3.2.1 *Please* as a formula

- Quirk et al. (1985): *please* is one of a group of adverbs used to express politeness and conventional manners, eg. *kindly, cordially*
- Biber et al. (1999) and Fraser (1996): a standalone marker with a purely pragmatic, interaction-facilitating meaning

- Wichmann (2004): change of meaning in *please* (away from literal ‘if it pleases you’) suggests contemporary *please* = “a courtesy formula which acknowledges debt with greater or lesser sense of obligation” (Wichmann 2004, p.1547)
- Wichmann (2004) also notes that utterance position varies with speaker intention:
 - Utterance-initial *please* rare in indirect requests
 - Utterance-medial *please* exclusively in indirect requests
 - Utterance-final *please* ‘favored’ by indirect requests; only occurs in ‘private’ (i.e. informal) speech

3.2.2 Sato (2008): different types of *please*

- Comparison of American and New Zealand English; no apparent differences between the two dialects
- Notes that notion of ‘request’ often left undefined in the pragmatic literature - therefore focuses on a distributional account
- Analysed position of *please* within “turn-constructive units” (TCUs)
- TCU-initial and -medial positions associated with “directive acts” such as demands and pleas; less conventionality and more speaker-individuality in these uses of *please*
- TCU-medial and -final positions associated with politeness and social convention
- Shows that certain clause types are significantly more likely to permit *please* than others:
 - Imperatives
 - (YN) interrogatives
 - ‘Semi-free-standing’ clauses, e.g. “Yes please”

Questions and problems:

- What is ‘speaker individuality’?
- What makes a TCU more or less relevant to how *please* is used than clause/sentence structure?
- Clear distributional differences ignored!

3.3 So what is *please*?

Is it an adverb? A free-standing marker? Does it modify, or is it just inserted?

- In speech act theory traditionally treated as an adverbial, but differs from other ‘courtesy’ adverbs
 - Cannot be modified
 - Can constitute a tone unit on its own
 - Seems to be available in multiple positions in the clause
- Others separate the idea of modification from characterization of adverbs; Bach & Harnish (1979) dub *please* an “illocutionary modifier”
- Sadock (1974) distinguishes between sentence-internal *please* and a ‘free-standing’ *please*
- The pragmatic tradition prefers categorization as an ‘insert’ (Biber et al. 1999) or a ‘basic discourse marker’ (Fraser 1996)

Points of agreement:

- *Please* is, if not extra-sentential, at least outside of the proposition conveyed in a sentence
- It has two possible elements of meaning, as a politeness marker and as a marker of requests, broadly construed

Points of divergence:

- Pragmaticists suggest that *please* is “largely restricted to spoken language” (Stubbs 1983, p.72); semanticists/speech act theorists make no special claims about this
- Semanticists et al suggest that requesting *please* is in some way connected to the mood of the sentence; it is not simply parenthetical and is in some way connected to the clausal spine

3.4 Moving forward...

I will NOT be primarily focusing on:

- Social obligations/relative social status of the interlocutors
- Conventional and unconventional request strategies...or convention in general
- The affect of (either) interlocutor
- The precise nature of the speaker’s desired outcome, i.e. indirect speech acts and subtext

- Only analysing “request” sentences - all sentences with *please* in each of the corpora will be taken into account

I WILL be focusing on:

- The syntactic characteristics of *please* w.r.t. modification, co-ordination etc.
- The syntactic position of *please*
- The types of the clauses in which *please* appears
- Interplay between clause type and syntactic position

And a note:

- I use the term **request** to refer to any utterance which directly demands an action on the part of the addressee, whether that action contains a linguistic component or not. This does not mean that all information-seeking questions are requests. Essentially, it will be shown that:
 - Information-seeking questions which are also requests will be able to host *please* and have some kind of modal force
 - Information-seeking questions which are not requests cannot host *please*
- This definition of **request** includes all acts by which the speaker requires an action of the addressee regardless of politeness/obligation. This therefore includes (but is not limited to):
 - Commands
 - Orders
 - Desires
 - Requests without any obligation
- I will think of requests as a grammatically-marked illocutionary act. Sentences which are used to indirectly request something by means of subtext are not requests in the sense I lay out here

4 An investigation of *please*

4.1 Distribution of *please*

4.1.1 Clause types

While *please* can appear sentence-initially, -medially or -finally, it seems that there are some restrictions according to clause types:

- (6) Interrogative clauses
 - a. Please can I have a beer?
 - b. Can I please have a beer?
 - c. Can I have a beer please?
- (7) Imperative clauses
 - a. Please get me a beer
 - b. Get (*please) me (*please) a beer
 - c. Get me a beer please
- (8) Declarative clauses
 - a. *Please I'll have a beer³
 - b. *I'll please have a beer
 - c. I'll have a beer please
- (9) (Outside of question-response contexts)
 - a. *There's a mouse there please

4.1.2 Corpus study: the ICE-GB corpus

The ICE-GB corpus contains 199 instances of *please* (excluding the verb *to please*). The tables below show the distribution of *please* in different clausal positions and across different clause types.

Table 1 shows how *please* is distributed across different clausal positions in the ICE-GB corpus. It shows that clause-initial *please* is more than twice as common as clause-final *please*, which is in turn twice as common as clause-medial *please*.

Table 1: Clausal position of *please* in the ICE-GB corpus (overall)

Position	Number of occurrences
Clause-initial	114
Clause-medial (VP edge)	27
Clause-final	50
Other (e.g. standalone)	8
Total	199

Table 2 shows the clausal position of *please* in the corpus's speech texts: the majority of clause-final *pleases* appear in the speech part of the corpus, and clause-final *please* is more common than any other position.

³Note that this linear string is possible with a prosodic break between *please* and the rest of the clause:
 (i) Please - I'll have a beer
 In this case *please* is a standalone item, a request in and of itself and is not part of the same clause as "I'll have a beer", and is such is not clause-initial in the same way as (6a), for example.

Table 2: Clausal position of *please* in the ICE-GB corpus (speech only)

Position	Number of occurrences
Clause-initial	28
Clause-medial (VP edge)	6
Clause-final	46
Other (e.g. standalone)	6
Total	86

Table 3 shows which types of clause cooccur with *please* in the speech part of the corpus. *Please* predominantly occurs with the clause types typically used to perform requests, namely interrogatives and imperatives.

Table 3: Clause types with *please* in the ICE-GB corpus (speech)

Clause type	Number of occurrences
Declaratives	4
Fragments (e.g. yes, no, NP)	17
Standalone	2
Interrogatives	29
Imperatives	35
Conditional	1
Total	86

Table 4 shows the clause types which cooccur with *please* in the written part of the corpus. The results are the same as in table 3, though there are fewer interrogatives and fragments in the written corpus.

Table 4: Clause types with *please* in the ICE-GB corpus (written)

Clause type	Number of occurrences
Declaratives	3
Standalone	3
Interrogatives	18
Imperatives	82
Total	106

4.1.3 The tricky case of declaratives

The corpus data above shows that *please* appears in the following declarative sentences:

- (10) (In speech contexts)
- I'll have white ice cream please
 - I'll have strawberry ice cream please
 - So I ask for single questions please

- d. I want to hear what the witness says please
- (11) (In writing - N.B. all from literary texts)
- a. “Please, he’s my son.”
 - b. “Please, Brett [...] I hate to see you angry like this.”
 - c. The policeman said, “I’d like your full name and address, please.”

Note that almost all of these uses of *please* are utterance-final, including:

- (12)
- a. Responses to questions, e.g. I’ll have strawberry ice cream please
 - b. Overt requests, e.g. So I ask for single questions please
 - c. Indirect requests, e.g. I want to hear what the witness says please

The examples of utterance-initial *please* in declaratives have some particular characteristics:

- They are both non-attested, dramatic representations of speech
- They are not integrated into the syntax of the declarative clause, but act as standalone requests in and of themselves separately from the speech act communicated by the declarative clause

But examples of integrated utterance-medial *please* are attested!

- (13) Persons anxious to write their names will please do so on this stone only.⁴

4.1.4 Summary

- Clause-initial *please* is the most common position overall in the corpus
- Clause-initial *please* predominates in writing
- Clause-final *please* is much more common in speech than in writing
- *Please* is rare with declaratives in either speech or writing; examples of *please* in declaratives in writing are all found in literary examples of direct speech and constitute separate acts from the declarative they appear with
- Amongst the *pleases* in declaratives in speech:
 - Two are clearly responses to a question
 - The other two are indirect requests
 - All are utterance-final

⁴Taken from [http : //www.reddit.com/r/funny/comments/2gr9ol/a_very_british_response_to_graffiti/](http://www.reddit.com/r/funny/comments/2gr9ol/a_very_british_response_to_graffiti/) - thanks to Jason Overfelt for sharing this.

4.2 Acquisition of *please*

Advantages of *please* over other proposed speech act heads, e.g. *hai* in Romanian:

- *Please* can appear in two positions in English; allows us to look at when it is first used in each position (not available with exclusively sentence-initial *hai*)
- Clause-initial *please*'s links to questions gives us a well-known acquisition clue to look for and compare with the emergence of *please* - namely emergence of CP

Unsurprisingly, there is a LOT of support for use of *please* from caregivers (all examples from the Manchester corpus (Theakston et al. 2001)):

- (14) Aran (2;2)
MOT: no
MOT: and I wouldn't be putting it in there anyway unless you said
please
CHI: please
MOT: it doesn't matter
MOT: too late now
- (15) Aran (2;3)
MOT: well if you want somebody to do something what do you say ?
CHI: please
MOT: oh good
MOT: I'm glad you know that
- (16) Aran (2;10)
CHI: can I have my gun back now ?
MOT: well if you ask for it nicely you might get it
CHI: yes please
MOT: try please may I have my gun back , Mummy
CHI: please may I have my gun
MOT: well no
MOT: not if you're going to be silly on the settee .

Taking the first three subcorpora of the Manchester corpus (Anne, Aran and Becky), there were 324 uses of *please* by the children. There is a clear pattern in children's use of *please*:

- *Please* is used from the earliest files, often prompted by the caregiver, as a standalone fragment or with other fragments like *yes* or NPs such as *that*
- These uses of *please* are exclusively utterance-final
- Clause-initial (not standalone) uses of *please* emerge later and always contain (at least) a verb:

Table 5: First uses of sentence-initial *please*

Child	Age	Utterance
Anne	2;2	please [can I] have some
Aran	2;4	please race it mummy
Becky	2;6	please take the card off please

- There are no uses of utterance-initial *please* with fragments, NPs or declarative clauses in any of the children’s speech
- In all cases, utterance-initial *please* occurs after or around the same time as the child has acquired CP; i.e. s/he forms analysed wh-questions with inversion of a full auxiliary:⁵

Table 6: Children’s first evidence of CP compared with age of first use of utterance-initial *please*

Child	Age of U-I <i>please</i>	Age of acquisition of CP	First evidence of CP
Anne	2;2	1;11	what did you do/where are moneys please
Aran	2;4	2;5	what is this one ⁶
Becky	2;6	2;2	what is that

4.3 (Other) characteristics of *please*

Embedded contexts

Please is restricted in embedded contexts: we find examples like (17) but examples in reported speech like (18) are bad:

(17) I wonder if someone might please check the books ICE-GB

(18) He asked me whether (*please) I would go to the dance with him

However, *please* is permitted in embedded clauses in which the centre of evaluation/point of orientation has shifted from the speaker, for example in free indirect discourse (FID) or dialects which have been shown independently to embed full speech acts, such as embedded inverted interrogatives (EII) in a number of English dialects:⁷

(19) She asked if she might see a hand-mirror please ICE-GB

(20) a. He asked me please would I go to the dance with him
b. He asked me would I please go to the dance with him North West English

⁵This is a particularly strict set of criteria for the acquisition of CP, hence 6 seems to suggest that Aran uses utterance-initial *please* before having acquired CP.

⁷See McCloskey (2006), Krifka (2014), Woods (2014a) amongst others for more information on this phenomenon.

Modification

Unlike adverbs but like functional heads, *please* cannot be modified:

- (21) a. *Very please (cf. ^{OK}very kindly)
b. *Hugely please (cf. ^{OK}hugely grateful)
c. *Many please (cf. ^{OK}many thanks)

Note that “pretty please”, available in some dialects of English, does not denote ‘prettier’ pleases than standalone *please*, and as such is just an idiom.

Co-ordination

Adverbs can typically be stacked or co-ordinated, where functional heads in the same projection cannot:

- (22) *gehen Sie doch und mal zum Arzt
go you PRT and PRT to.the doctor
“Go to the doctors!” Coniglio (2005, p.30)
- (23) *Please and fine, fetch me the bucket Own example

The importance of modals?

To this point I have treated all interrogatives as equal. However, there are clearly some interrogatives which naturally cooccur with *please*, and others which do not:

- (24) a. Please will you find me a partner?
b. Please can you persuade him to come?
c. ?*Please did you get that dress at Macy’s?
d. ?*Please where did you get that dress?

Sadock says that there is no difference in *meaning* between examples like (24a) and (24c) that should make them more or less appropriate w.r.t *please*, comparing them with the difference between (a) and (b) below:

- (25) a. Feed the cat
b. Feed the dog

In the case that you only have a cat, telling me to feed the dog is inappropriate due to the meaning of the sentence. Sadock argues that this is not the case with (24a) and (24c) because a context could be constructed in which (24c) too is grammatical, but I argue this is not the case - the *structure* of the sentence must change to make (24c) grammatical:

- (26) A really wants to know where B got the dress because owning the dress will make A’s life immeasurably happier, but B is refusing to tell A where the dress came from. A resorts to guessing.
A: Please - did you get the dress in Macy’s?

Given that not all, but only some interrogatives (i.e. those with requesting force) permit *please*, a simplistic one-to-one correspondence with clause type and force seems unfounded.

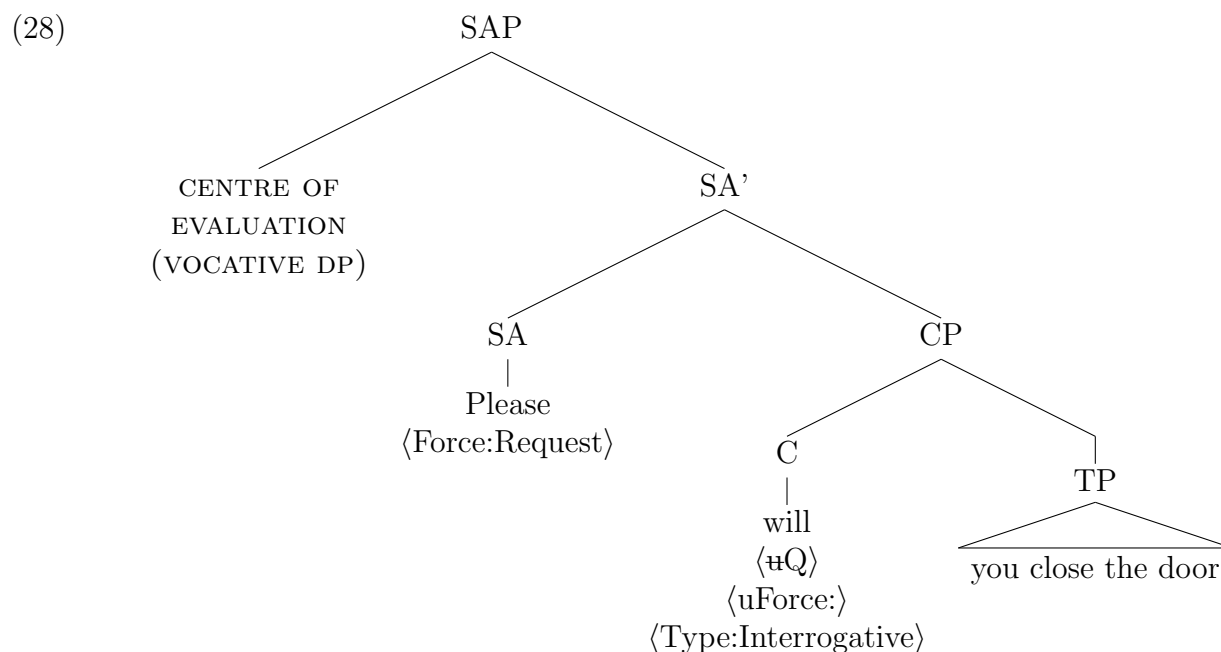
5 Is *please* a speech act head?

5.1 Clause-initial *please*

- There seems to be evidence to suggest that, by Hill's (and later) criteria, clause-initial *please* could be a speech act head
 - Correct position in clause (highest possible functional item)
 - Only items which can precede clause-initial *please* are speech act adverbs and vocatives (overt expression of addressee in Hill's (2007b) theory)
 - *Please* is derived from a verbal root though it does not inflect
 - Not truth-conditional but does impact on the interpretation of the sentence; communicates something about the requirements of the utterance on the addressee
 - Clause-initial *please* is restricted to YN interrogatives, imperatives: that is, forms used to directly express requests
 - Portner (2004) suggests that interrogatives and imperatives differ from declaratives in that the 'centre of evaluation' is the addressee, not the speaker
- Note that clause-initial *please* is associated with politeness and convention, but can be used in non-polite contexts without degradation in grammaticality (N.B. harder to use clause-final *please* in non-polite contexts)

The proposed structure for a sentence like (27) is shown in (28):

(27) Please will you close the door?



- The fact of *please*'s being the speech act head and encoding illocutionary force explains why it is available in dialects which embed speech acts (e.g. those with embedded inverted questions) and not those which do not

- Embedded clauses in English are generally assumed to be clause-typed but unspecified for illocutionary force (read: the original speaker’s intentions)
- Krifka (2014) and Woods (2014a) discuss evidence for embedded speech acts, such as embedded inverted questions, containing an extra layer of structure which bestows illocutionary force on the embedded clause

5.2 ...and non-clause-initial *pleases*?

Clause-medial *please*

- Still seems to be restricted to requests
- Has a slightly wider distribution than clause-initial *please*: declaratives with deontic modal force
- Slightly different in interpretation also; linked to forced politeness/frustration (common in situations with set conventions or a big disparity in seniority between interlocutors)
- Located on the edge of the vP above vP-edge adverbs e.g. *always*:

(29) Customers should please always wipe their feet before entering

Clause-final *please*

- Clause-final *please* also have a wider distribution than clause-initial *please*:
 - With fragments e.g. yes, no, NPs
 - In declaratives (e.g. responses to questions)
 - Certain kinds of indirect requests (e.g. I want to hear what the witness says please)
 - (Marginally possible in) non-speech act embedded contexts (e.g. I wonder if someone might please check the books)
 - Wh-questions, as in (30):

(30) Johnny, who discovered the Bronx, please? (Sadock 1974, p.121)

- Clause-final *please* is much more closely linked with politeness contexts, as Sato (2008) noted, e.g. responses to questions, indirect requests, and is markedly less common with requesting strategies which tend to impose obligation, e.g. imperatives

Non-clause-initial *please* as an adverb-like particle

- For the reasons detailed above, I analyse non-clause-initial *please* as an adverb-like particle in the vein of Cardinaletti (2011)
 - They do not enter into Agree relationships with any other element in the clause

- They are merged in IP, not in CP
- They may appear in a wider range of contexts than speech act *please*
- This is not a stipulative nor a superfluous move:
 - Explains different distributions
 - Explains different interpretive effects, which are unlikely to derive simply from a different surface position in the sentence

6 Consequences for speech act theory

- Given the current understanding of what a speech act head might be, it seems that *please* fits the bill
- Its meaning, when in clause-initial position, is to overtly mark the sentence as a request rather than any other type of illocutionary act; see the three-way distinction observed by Sadock:

- (31)
- a. Can you close the window?
 - b. Can you close the window, please?
 - c. Please can you close the window?

- Examples (31a) and (31b) could be genuine information-seeking questions about the addressee's ability to close the window
- Example (31c), on the other hand, can only be interpreted as a request

However:

- This suggests that Coniglio & Zegrean's (2012) proposal that C is split into illocutionary force and clause type projections separately from the particle might benefit from a slight alteration; I propose that the particle *is* the head of the illocutionary force projection and that its role is to mark the illocutionary force of the sentence overtly
- Furthermore, their proposal that particles are linked to clause type through feature sharing may also be amended - there may be a *tendency* for certain particles to appear with certain clause types, but the difference between YN and wh-questions w.r.t the distribution of *please* is harder to capture in Coniglio and Zegrean's system
- Finally, this analysis of *please* may begin to clarify the nature of the arguments of the speech act head
 - Correlation between the availability of an overt speech act marker and primary role of the addressee (both in English and Romanian)
 - Also correlates with availability of embedded speech acts in English (only embedded root interrogatives and imperatives are possible)

- Is it possible that this is evidence for (an updated version of) Chomsky’s (1995) idea of weak declarative C? At least in English?
 - To take one step further - is the speaker ever projected in syntax? Is the addressee the only discourse participant which may be projected in syntax in English when it is necessary?
 - It seems possible (and indeed minimal) that the speaker need not be represented in syntax, as s/he is inalienably connected with the structure by virtue of having produced it
 - Note the same cannot be said for the addressee — nothing in (English) declarative sentences picks out the specific addressee, though it is important in interrogatives and imperatives that they are addressed to the correct person
- Questions remain. . .

7 Conclusions

- There are two types of *please* in English
 - Speech act head *please*
 - Politeness marker *please*
- Speech act head *please* has the following key characteristics
 - It is clause-initial
 - It only occurs with imperatives and a restricted subset of interrogatives
 - It overtly marks the requesting force of the sentence in which it appears
 - It is usually prosodically part of the clause it gives force to (exceptions include standalone *please*)
- Politeness marker *please* is characterised as follows:
 - Freer positioning within the clause - initially, medially or finally
 - Need not be prosodically part of the clause (must be separated by comma intonation in initial position)
 - Combines with a wider range of clause types, including fragments and declaratives
 - Marks politeness rather than requesting force
- Note that speech act *please* is only possible with direct requests — indirect requests do not have grammatically-marked requesting force, but achieve the *effect* of a request through other factors such as context and subtext
- I have shown that *please* enters into an Agree relationship with the clause-typing functional head, Force, endowing it with requesting force

- However, I refute Coniglio and Zegrean’s (2012) idea that the particle is separate from the speech act head and agrees in clause type with the Force head
 - I propose that *please* IS the overt realisation of the speech act head
- Questions remain over the representation of discourse participants in syntax
 - I tentatively suggest that only the addressee is (when necessary) represented, that the speaker is not in syntax but connected with the syntactic structure inalienably (by virtue of being the producer of it)

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